Combat

Determine Surprise → Establish Positions → Roll Initiative → Take Turns → Begin the Next Round

1) The DM determines who is surprised as combat is starting by comparing the Stealth checks of anyone hiding with the Passive Perception score of each creature on the opposing side.

2) The DM works with the players to determine where each of their characters are, either by using their marching order or their stated positions in the area when combat began.

   Then the DM determines where each of the opposing creatures are.

3) Players roll initiative by making a Dexterity check, adding any bonuses to initiative they might have.

   The DM rolls initiative for the opposing creatures and may decide to make one roll for entire groups of identical creatures.

   The initiative order is then arranged from highest to lowest. This becomes the turn order and persists through each round.

   If a tie occurs between two players, they may decide who goes first; otherwise, the DM decides the outcome of the tie.

4) Each participant in the battle takes their turn in the order of initiative.

5) After everyone involved in the combat has had a turn, the round ends. Repeat Steps 4 & 5 until the combat is over.

Your Turn

Combat is organized into a system of rounds and turns. A round represents about 6 seconds of in game time, during which each participant takes its own turn according to the initiative order. After every participant has had a turn a new round begins. Since a round represents a finite amount of time, several factors will limit how you interact with the environment and other participants. The following action types are limited to use during your turn unless stated otherwise; however, they can be performed in any order you choose.

Movement

During your turn you can move a distance up to your speed. You can break up your movement, using a portion of your speed before or after other actions you take on your turn, including between attacks. Movement through difficult terrain is twice as difficult, costing you two feet of movement for every one.

Interaction

During your turn you can communicate freely within the game (within reason). You can also interact with one object or feature for free as part of your movement or action. Examples can be found below.

Action

Your Action represents a major part of your turn. You can only perform one Action per turn. The most common Action is the 'Attack' action, but there are a variety of other options detailed in the table below.

Bonus Action

Your Bonus Action allows you to use various class features, spells, and other abilities that specifically state that they may be activated using a Bonus Action. You can only perform one Bonus Action per turn.

Reaction

Your Reaction is an action that is made in response to a trigger of some kind and as such it can be used when it is not your turn. Once you use your Reaction you cannot use it again until the start of your next turn. Opportunity Attacks are the most common type of Reaction and are made when an enemy leaves your reach. Various class features, spells, and other abilities can also be used as a Reaction.

Interactions

Draw or sheathe a weapon
Open or close a door
Withraw an item from your pack
Pick up a dropped or unattended item
Hand an item to another player
Throw a lever or switch
Turn a key in a lock
Pull the hood of your cloak up

Actions

Attack	Make a melee or ranged attack, adding your relevant ability modifier and proficiency bonus if applicable.
Cast a Spell	Cast a spell you are able to cast according to the rules of your spellcasting class. This spell must have a casting time of '1 action.'
Dash	You may move an extra distance this turn equal to your current speed after applying any modifiers.
Disengage	Your movement for the rest of your turn does no provoke attacks of opportunity.
Dodge	Until the start of your next turn and as long as your speed is not 0 and you are not Incapacitated, attacks made against you have disadvantage and you have advantage on Dexterity saving throws.
Escape Grapple	Make an Athletics or Acrobatics check contested by the grappler's Athletics check to escape a Grapple.
Grapple	The target of your Grapple must be no more than one size category larger than you and it must be within your Reach. When you take the Attack action you can forego one of your weapon attacks to try to Grapple your target. Make an Athletics check contested by the target's Athletics or Acrobatics check (their choice). If you succeed your target suffers from the Grappled condition.
Help	Your target gains advantage on the next ability check they make before the start of your next turn.
Hide	Make a Stealth check to attempt to become hidden.
Improvise	Take an action not described here, providing your DM allows it. E.g. Break down a door, intimidate foes.
Ready	Ready an Action for use later during the round. Decide what circumstances might trigger your action. When the trigger occurs you may choose to spend your Reaction after the trigger finishes to perform the readied Action or move a distance up to your speed (if you readied Dash). If you Ready a spell it requires Concentration until it is triggered.
Search	Depending on the nature of your search, make a Perception or Investigation check.
Shove	As Grapple, but if you succeed you instead may choose to either knock your target prone or push it 5 feet away from you.
Stabilize	Use a Healer's Kit or make a Medicine check with a DC of 10 to cause a dying creature to become Stable.